



WAR MACHINES



Hand grenade

Going bang!



Gunpowder was first used in China more than 1,000 years ago for making fireworks.



In 1605, Guy Fawkes tried to blow up the English Parliament with gunpowder.



In 1867, Alfred Nobel invented a very powerful explosive called dynamite.

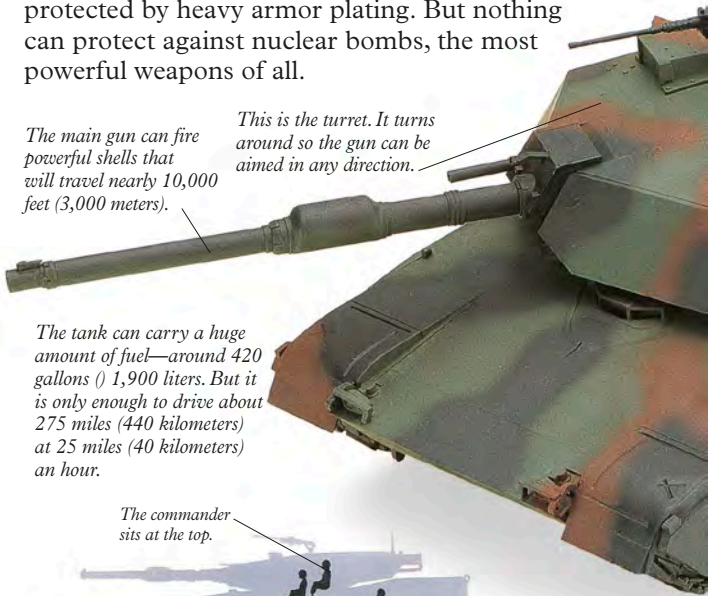


An aircraft carrier

Modern armies have all sorts of weapons, from rifles and grenades for fighting a single enemy, to bombs and missiles for attacking large targets. Soldiers can go into battle riding in a tank—a huge gun on wheels protected by heavy armor plating. But nothing can protect against nuclear bombs, the most powerful weapons of all.

The main gun can fire powerful shells that will travel nearly 10,000 feet (3,000 meters).

This is the turret. It turns around so the gun can be aimed in any direction.



The tank can carry a huge amount of fuel—around 420 gallons () 1,900 liters. But it is only enough to drive about 275 miles (440 kilometers) at 25 miles (40 kilometers) an hour.

The commander sits at the top.

The driver sits inside at the front, and uses mirrors to see what is happening outside.

The gunner aims the main gun using a thermal imaging sight. This picks up the heat given out by enemy targets.

The loader loads the main gun with explosive shells. He also operates the radio.